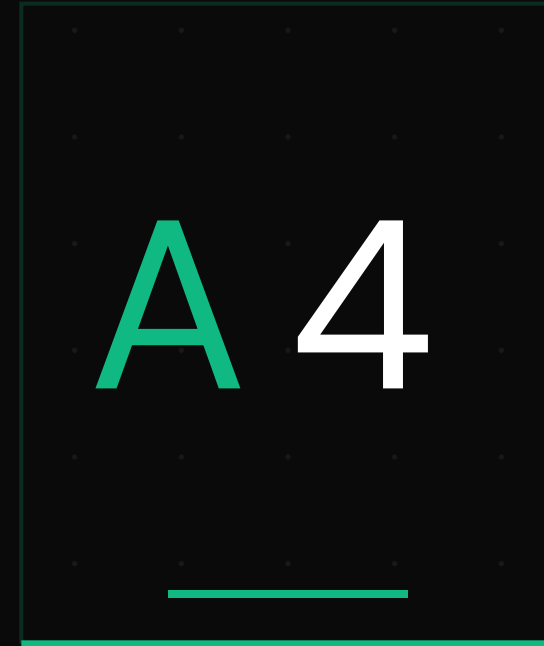




The AI-powered financial workspace that replaces the spreadsheets, dashboards,
and advisors that small businesses and individuals can't afford.

Most people and small businesses manage their finances across a mess of spreadsheets, bank apps, and disconnected tools — losing thousands to blind spots that a CFO or advisor would catch in minutes. But CFOs cost \$150k+ and advisors won't touch small accounts.

We're building the AI that will.

— ONE-LINER

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Financial Blindness at Every Scale

A freelancer with three income streams, a small business owner with \$400k in annual revenue, an individual trying to coordinate a 401(k), a brokerage account, student loans, and a budget — none of them have a unified view of their financial life. The tools that exist force them to choose: oversimplified consumer apps that track spending but can't model scenarios, or enterprise software that costs more than their accountant.

The damage is constant and compounding:

- Fragmentation drag.

The average small business owner checks four different platforms to understand their cash position. Invoices in one tool, expenses in another, bank balances in a third, tax estimates on a napkin. Every context switch is a decision delayed, and delayed financial decisions have dollar costs.

- Analytical poverty.

"What happens if I hire in Q3?" "Can I afford to prepay this debt?" "Am I actually profitable after owner's comp?" These are \$10,000–\$100,000 questions that get answered with gut instinct because the tools to model them properly cost \$500/month or require a finance degree.

— THE DAMAGE COMPOUNDS IN EVERY DIRECTION

Three more leaks, all invisible until they aren't.

- Tax drag.

Small businesses routinely overpay taxes — missing deductions, misclassifying expenses, ignoring quarterly estimate optimization, failing to time major purchases. Individuals miss Roth conversion windows, hold tax-inefficient assets in the wrong accounts, and leave tax-loss harvesting on the table. Each mistake is small. Compounded across years, they're enormous.

- Cash drag.

Money sits idle in low-yield checking accounts. Receivables go uncollected for weeks past due. Subscription costs creep up unnoticed. The financial equivalent of a slow leak — invisible until you realize you've been losing \$200/month for three years.

- Decision paralysis disguised as caution.

Some people avoid all the mistakes above by simply not acting — not investing surplus cash, not expanding the business, not negotiating that lease, not consolidating that debt. The opportunity cost of inaction, compounded over a decade, dwarfs most of the explicit mistakes combined.

THE CRUEL MATH

Financial blindness compounds in every direction.

COMPOUNDING COST OF INACTION

The cruel math: a \$5,000 inefficiency at 30 isn't a \$5,000 problem. At a 7% real return, it's \$75,000 at 65. A small business that delays hiring by six months because it couldn't model the cash flow impact doesn't lose six months of salary — it loses the revenue that employee would have generated. Financial blindness compounds in every direction.



Three curves are crossing for the first time.

01

The "spreadsheet ceiling" is real and universal.

Individuals and small businesses have outgrown basic apps but can't justify enterprise tools. The mid-market for financial intelligence — flexible enough for real decisions, affordable enough for a one-person company — has been structurally empty.

02

The advice gap has widened, not narrowed.

Fractional CFOs start at \$3k/month. Bookkeepers track history but don't advise on the future. Financial advisors require \$250k+ in assets. The people who need the most help have the fewest options.

03

LLMs crossed the threshold for financial reasoning.

As of 2025, frontier models can parse financial documents, reason through multi-step scenarios, and explain tradeoffs at a level that would have required a CPA or CFP just a few years ago. An AI that can read your invoices, understand your debt structure, model your tax scenarios, and explain the tradeoffs in plain language — that product was impossible two years ago. It's a wedge today.

The window is open. Incumbents are structurally disadvantaged: QuickBooks and Xero are accounting-first and can't reason. Consumer apps (Mint, Monarch) track but can't advise. Traditional advisors can't serve small accounts profitably. And horizontal AI tools (ChatGPT, Claude) have no persistent financial context — the user has to re-explain everything every session.

A Financial Workspace, Not a Dashboard.

A4 is a financial workspace — a persistent, contextual environment where your entire financial picture lives on an infinite canvas, and an AI advisor named Paige reasons over all of it. The distinction matters. Dashboards display data. Chatbots answer questions. A workspace knows you: your accounts, your invoices, your debts, your portfolio, your budget, your tax situation, your last conversation. It proactively surfaces decisions you should be making, flags problems before they become crises, and models scenarios you didn't know you should be running.

01

Unified over fragmented.

Every financial primitive — budgets, invoices, receipts, subscriptions, accounts, portfolios, debts, net worth, P&L, cash flow, tax estimates, loan models, projections — lives in one workspace on one canvas. No more alt-tabbing between six apps to understand your financial position.

02

Proactive over reactive.

A great CFO doesn't wait for you to ask about cash flow — they call you before it's a problem. Paige operates the same way: surfacing tax-loss harvesting in November, flagging subscription creep, alerting you when receivables are aging, modeling the impact of decisions before you make them.

03

Educational over prescriptive.

We don't tell users what to do. We show the tradeoffs, quantify the impact, explain the underlying principle, and let them decide. Every interaction leaves them more financially capable than the last.

A workspace with 27 canvas tools built for financial reasoning.

A user creates a workspace — for their freelance business, their personal finances, their side project, their household — and immediately has access to 27 canvas tools purpose-built for financial reasoning:

1 A complete financial toolkit.

Budgets, invoices, receipts, subscription trackers, account overviews, portfolio managers, debt planners, net worth trackers, P&L statements, balance sheets, cash flow views, tax estimators, loan calculators, projection models, breakeven analysis, depreciation schedules, rent-vs-buy comparisons. Each one is a live, interactive card on the canvas — not a static report.

2 Document intelligence.

Upload bank statements, tax returns, receipts, contracts — PDFs, CSVs, Excel files, images. A4 extracts the data via OCR and embedding, makes it searchable, and feeds it into Paige's reasoning context. Your documents become queryable financial knowledge.

3 An AI that sees everything.

Paige doesn't just answer questions — she creates. "Set up a monthly budget for my freelance business" produces a fully populated budget card. "Create an invoice for Acme Corp" generates a complete invoice with line items. She reasons across every card, document, and data point in the workspace.

4 Scenario modeling.

"What if I take on \$50k in debt at 7% to expand?" "15-year vs 30-year mortgage — show me the math." "What's my breakeven if I raise prices 15%?" Side-by-side scenario comparisons with real numbers, generated in seconds.

5 Cross-workspace intelligence.

Query across all your workspaces simultaneously. "What's my total net worth across personal and business?" "Compare cash flow across all three projects." The AI sees the full picture even when your finances are organized into separate workspaces.

Tens of millions underserved by both consumer apps and enterprise tools.

● TAM

33M

small businesses in the U.S. alone, plus ~100 million individuals with investable assets or complex-enough finances to need more than a checking account app. Globally, several multiples larger.

● SAM

40–50M

potential users in the U.S. — small businesses with \$100k–\$5M in revenue, freelancers and contractors, and individuals with \$10k–\$500k in financial complexity — all underserved by both consumer apps and enterprise tools.

● WEDGE

One use case → many

The workspace model means users start with one use case (budgeting, invoicing, portfolio tracking) and expand as they realize the value of having everything in one place. The canvas is a natural expansion surface.

WILLINGNESS-TO-PAY ANCHOR

QuickBooks charges \$30–\$200/month for accounting alone. Financial advisors charge 1% of AUM. Fractional CFOs start at \$3k/month. A4 can credibly price at \$15–\$50/month and deliver more integrated value than any of them for the segment we serve.

Subscription, aligned with the user.

- Subscription

Tiered monthly/annual pricing. Free tier with limited workspaces and AI interactions to drive adoption; paid tiers unlock unlimited workspaces, proactive monitoring, advanced scenario modeling, document processing, and cross-workspace intelligence.

- No conflicts of interest

We don't sell financial products. We don't earn commissions. We don't sell user data. A4's only incentive is to make the user's financial decisions better. Alignment is the brand.

VAULT ENCRYPTION
 Passphrase → PBKDF2 → AES-256-GCM
plaintext never stored

FUTURE REVENUE EXTENSIONS · DELIBERATELY DEPRIORITIZED

Premium tier with on-demand human CPA/CFP review, B2B2C distribution through employers and accelerators, API access for accountants managing client workspaces.

Nothing on this list combines all four.

CATEGORY	EXAMPLES	WHY THEY DON'T SOLVE THIS
Accounting software	QuickBooks, Xero, FreshBooks	Backward-looking record-keeping; no AI reasoning, no personal finance, no scenario modeling
Personal finance apps	Monarch, YNAB, Copilot	Budgeting and tracking only; can't model scenarios, create invoices, or manage a business
Robo-advisors	Betterment, Wealthfront	Allocate capital, don't advise on decisions; investment-only, no business finance
Traditional advisors	RIAs, CFPs, CPAs	\$250k+ minimums or \$200+/hour; won't serve small accounts or small businesses
Spreadsheets	Excel, Google Sheets	Infinitely flexible, zero intelligence; no AI, no proactive insights, breaks constantly
General-purpose AI	ChatGPT, Claude	No persistent context, no account data, no canvas, no proactive monitoring
Enterprise FP&A	Anaplan, Mosaic, Runway	\$50k+/year; designed for finance teams of 5+, not founders and freelancers

Nothing on this list combines unified financial data, an interactive canvas, AI reasoning, and proactive intelligence at a price point accessible to individuals and small businesses.

Trust-led, community-rooted, productized to spread.

Creator-led acquisition.

Finance creators on YouTube, TikTok, and Substack have massive trust with our demographic. The canvas is inherently visual and shareable — a 60-second screen recording of Paige building a complete budget or modeling a scenario is organic content that markets itself.

Community-first.

r/smallbusiness, r/freelance, r/personalfinance, Indie Hackers, FIRE communities — these are communities full of people actively managing their own finances and hungry for better tools. We earn credibility by being demonstrably better and genuinely aligned.

Productized virality.

Every workspace produces artifacts worth sharing — invoices sent to clients, budget breakdowns shared with partners, scenario models shared with co-founders. Each one is a touchpoint with a non-user.

B2B2C wedge.

Accelerators, coworking spaces, and employer financial wellness programs are natural distribution channels. "Give every employee/founder access to an AI financial workspace" is a compelling benefit at our price point.

● ● ●

paige — content demo

"Create a budget breakdown I can share with my co-founder"

P

Generated a shareable budget card with 6 categories and a PDF export link.

GENERATED

Built. Shipping. Scaling.

BUILT TO DATE

Full-stack product, shipped.

- Full-stack product: 27 canvas item types, 21 database tables, 20 API routers, 36 AI tools
- AI advisor (Paige) with full canvas manipulation — creates, populates, and reasons over every card type
- Document pipeline: upload PDFs/CSVs/Excel/images, OCR extraction, semantic search via embeddings
- Cross-workspace intelligence: query and compare data across all user workspaces
- Scenario modeling engine: side-by-side financial comparisons with real calculations
- Vault encryption for sensitive financial data
- CI pipeline: lint, typecheck, unit tests, E2E tests, build — all passing

NEXT 6 MONTHS

Public beta & live data.

- Public beta launch with refined onboarding
- Account aggregation via Plaid (bank accounts, credit cards, investment accounts)
- Integration connectors: Stripe, QuickBooks, Plaid for live data sync
- Proactive intelligence layer: automated alerts, tax optimization nudges, cash flow warnings
- First paid tier; target early revenue validation

MONTHS 6–18

Goals, taxes, distribution.

- Goal-based planning (home purchase, hiring, expansion, retirement)
- Tax optimization deepening (quarterly estimates, Roth analysis, deduction optimization)
- B2B2C pilot with target accelerators and employer channels
- Mobile companion for approvals, alerts, and quick queries
- Path to Series A readiness

Team

RESERVED · SECTION IN PROGRESS

[To be completed]

The Ask

RESERVED • SECTION IN PROGRESS

[To be completed with specific raise amount, milestones, and use of funds]

 VISION

The financial workspace **for everyone.**

Within five years, every freelancer, small business owner, and financially active individual will open A4 alongside their bank account. Within ten, the idea that a person should manage their financial life across six disconnected apps and a spreadsheet will look as absurd as **navigating with paper maps.**

The deeper vision is structural. Small businesses are the backbone of every economy, and individuals are making increasingly complex financial decisions with increasingly inadequate tools. The advisory industry has watched this gap widen for decades and has no economic model to close it — humans don't scale, and human advice costs too much. AI **changes that math for the first time.**



We are building the financial workspace for everyone the existing financial system has failed to serve. The product is **Alto**. The mission is to make **sure that every financial decision** — from a \$50 subscription to a \$500,000 expansion — gets made with full context, clear tradeoffs, and zero conflicts of interest.

————— A4 · THANK YOU —————

